



Alumni Sharing: Working as an ESG consultant in Hong Kong 🇭🇰

CUHK(SZ) 2017 Cohort Diligentia College | Ouyang, Ying Lisa



ESG Advisory

Lisa OUYANG

Lisa OUYANG works for one of the KPMG (Advisory), based in Hong Kong office. She is specialized in the ESG pillar under Strategy and operations. She received her Master degree in Global Operations in the Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Bachelor degree in Applied Economics in the Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen.

With the expertise in supply chain management and the background in strategic consulting, Lisa focuses in the development of ESG Strategy, ESG Tech, ESG Due Diligence and Social Impact Investing. In year 2024, with the achievements and contribution in creating positive social impact, Lisa is granted the 2024 KPMG China Chairman's Award.



Part. 1 Life being as a consultant in Hong Kong

What is your imagination about working as a consultant...

Regular version



Get up & get ready for the day



Get to office & schedule for the day



Lunch, coffee chat with the colleagues, peers, boss



Client meetings, internal meetings, traveling to client office



Coffee break, communicate / align with team members



Wrap up for the day and plan for tomorrow

What is your imagination about working as a consultant...

My director's version



Get up & do sports in the morning (🏄, 🏃, ⚽, 🏀 ...)



Get to office & catch up on the project progress & set KPIs for the team



Client meetings, internal meetings, market outreach



Desktop lunch, catch up with the team members



Market event, business development, industry sharing



Review the deliverables / pitching materials prepared by team members

What is your imagination about working as a consultant...

My craziest day... ever



Regular day as a consultant working on deliverables and attending meetings with clients, fixing comments and adjusting (central)



Attend proposal pitching interview with the potential clients (Wan chai)



Attend department meetings (central)



Departmental after team meeting social night (LKF)

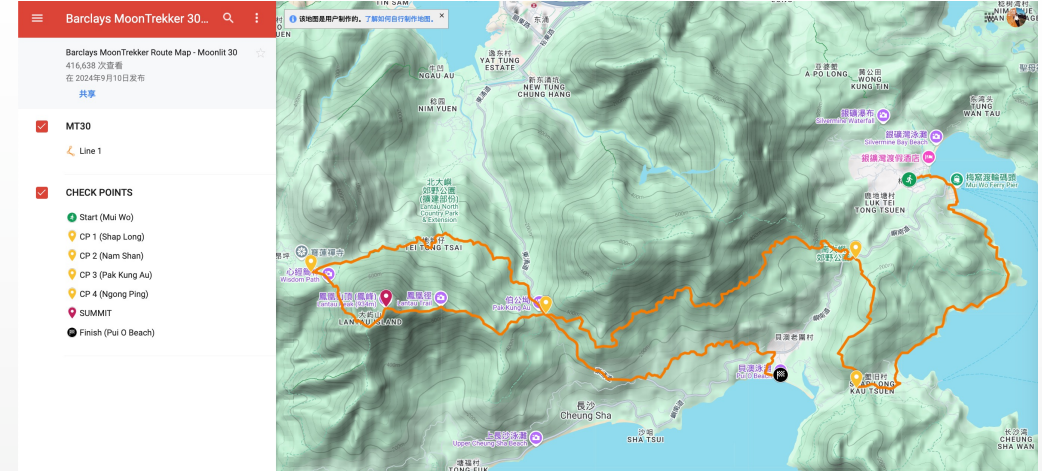


Arrive Moontrekker start point (Mui Wo)

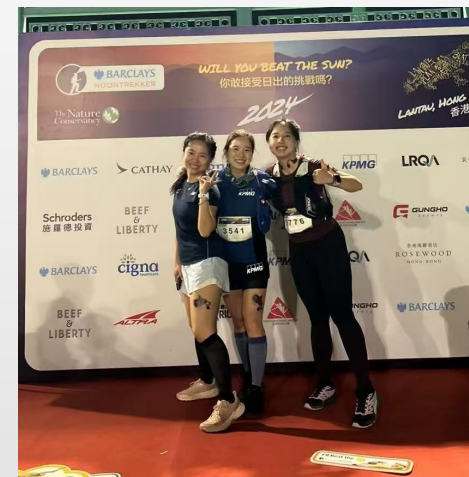


Hike for 31.5KM and arrive the end point after 8 hours' intense hike

What is Moon trekker?



Barclays MoonTrekker is an unique overnight trail event in Hong Kong that challenges participants to reach the summit of Lantau Peak before sunrise. It offers three route options: 30km, 40km, or an introductory 20km route. The 30km and 40km routes summit Lantau Peak, Hong Kong's second highest mountain, allowing runners to witness stunning dawn views if they "beat the sun."



What are the takeaways?

"To thrive in consulting, prioritize resilience under pressure, rapid learning agility, and sustained high energy — they're your non-negotiables."

Are you ready for it?



Part. 2 My focused areas

What is your imagination about working as an ESG consultant...

What exactly is ESG?

It stands for Environment, social and governance and... what is more?



Why there is ESG?

Diminishing margin of the economic welfare and increasing negative impacts of the externalities
Significant risk and loss resulting from the climate events
Development of the Doing Good of Business tradition in the western countries
...and?

Why I chose to be an ESG consultant

Self aspiration – doing good
Good industry exposure (e.g., banking, retail, transportation, philanthropy, public organization...)
Strong interactions with the C-level and get the insights of the operating mode
Well-trained your skills (e.g., relationship management, multitasking, group working...)

What aspects of being an ESG consultant that I don't like?

Less decision power, less control of results
Lack of self-reflections due to the given project period
Cannot choose what project you want to be on
Working hours are very fluctuated
.....

What is your imagination about working as an ESG consultant...

ESG in the globe 🌍

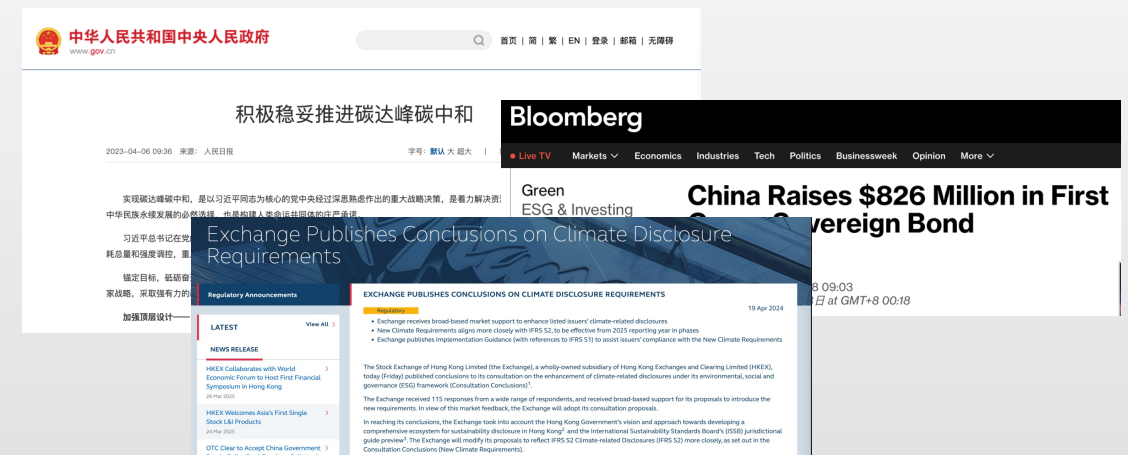
- EU: Europe (Leading in Regulation & Enforcement)
- USA: Growing but Politically Divided
- While federal policies may challenge ESG adoption, previous patterns show that market-driven demand and international expectations are likely to sustain its relevance
- Asia: Rapid Growth, Uneven Implementation

ESG in China / Hong Kong SAR 🇨🇳

- China: Strong state-led ESG push (carbon peak by 2030, carbon neutrality by 2060, green bonds)
- Hong Kong SAR: Hong Kong has adopted a "comply-or-explain" approach, Mandatory disclosure of climate-related risks (since 2025)

What ESG consultant do?

- ✳️ ESG Strategy Development
- ✳️ Risk Management & Due Diligence
- ✳️ Sustainable Finance & ESG Investing Support
- ✳️ ESG crossover e.g., Tech, Insurance, Philanthropy



What is your imagination about working as an ESG consultant...

ESG Job Market

Professional Service

Organization

MBB
Big four
Boutique (e.g., ERM)

Position & Role

- * Strategic consulting
- * ESG reporting, assurance, rating
- * ESG due diligence

In House

Retail, manufacturing, energy, real estate, NGOs, F&B, TMT, banking etc.

In house strategic consulting
ESG reporting

Investment Organization

- * Retail, manufacturing, energy, real estate, NGOs, F&B, TMT etc.
- * Banking

- * In house strategic consulting
- * ESG reporting

Rating Agency

S&P, Bloomberg, MSCI

ESG rating
ESG data platform
ESG performance analyst

Regulatory

- * HKMA, HKEX

Policy making



Part. 3 Reflections

Find your boat in your life

Why do we need a boat?

- Economic structural change → AI is disrupting mid-to-low-skill jobs, Sino-US relationship tension
- Collapse of traditional linear career narratives → 68% of the Gen Z is experiencing expectation gaps
- Change of the identity → From a player of the 'game' to be the designer of the 'game'

How can we find the boat?

- Career planning to set the direction of sailing (e.g., geographic location, industry, business nature, hybrid mode)
- Keep exploring and training up yourself
- Find your priorities & what really interest you (out of work) *

Career development is shifting from "climbing a ladder" to "sailing uncharted waters." The key is dynamic adaptability—not a fixed path, but the ability to course-correct.



Final words

"Keep exploring different ways of life and find what truly matters to you along the way."
